

# Siting Li

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## Education

### University of Washington

*Ph.D. student, advised by Prof. Simon S. Du*

Sept. 2023 – Present

Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering

### Tsinghua University

*B.Eng in Computer Science (Yao class)*

Sept. 2019 – Jun. 2023

Institute for Interdisciplinary Information Sciences

- Overall GPA: 3.78/4.0

## Research experiences

### Applied Scientist Intern at Amazon FAR (Frontier AI & Robotics)

Jun. 2025 – Mar. 2026

*Mentor: Dr. Yang Liu*

- Constructed a tokenizer comparison framework by extending the scaling analysis in language models to unified pure-autoregressive multimodal models with different discrete image tokenizers.

### Research Assistant at Department of Biostatistics, University of Washington

Dec. 2024 – Jun. 2025

*Mentors: Prof. Ting Ye, Prof. Simon S. Du*

- Designed and implemented new multimodal algorithm for predicting atrial fibrillation and heart failure using ECG and cardiac MRI data.

### Research Assistant at Allen School, University of Washington

Sept. 2023 – Feb. 2025

*Mentors: Prof. Simon S. Du, Prof. Pang Wei Koh*

- Designed and performed experiments investigating the vision-language alignment and encoder's ability in Vision-Language Models of different paradigms.

### Research Intern (Remote) at Allen School, University of Washington

Feb. 2022 – Jan. 2023

*Mentor: Prof. Simon S. Du*

- Built a theoretical framework for multi-modal contrastive learning by analyzing the gradient flow dynamics. Designed and tested regularizers for improving the quality of learned representations.

### Research Intern at MARS Lab, IIS, Tsinghua University

Jul. 2021 – Jun. 2023

*Mentor: Prof. Hang Zhao*

- Proposed an information-theoretical framework to explain the discrepancy among previous conclusions on multi-modal robustness. Designed and tested a metric and its calculating pipeline based on mutual information for evaluating modality complementarity on multi-modal datasets.

### Research Intern at IIS, Tsinghua University

Jul. 2020 – Jul. 2021

*Mentor: Prof. Yang Yu*

- Conducted experiments and plotted graphs to verify the DID counterfactual framework which clarifies the mechanisms how pixel normalization causes PG-GAN entanglement.

## Publications

1. Highlighting What Matters: Promptable Embeddings for Attribute-Focused Image Retrieval [\[link\]](#)  
**Siting Li**, Xiang Gao, Simon S. Du  
In Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2025 (Poster)
2. Exploring How Generative MLLMs Perceive More Than CLIP with the Same Vision Encoder [\[link\]](#)  
**Siting Li**, Pang Wei Koh, Simon S. Du  
In Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL) 2025 (Main Conference)  
In CVPR 2025 Multimodal Algorithmic Reasoning Workshop (Poster)

Preprints

1. RLVE: Scaling Up Reinforcement Learning for Language Models with Adaptive Verifiable Environments [\[link\]](#)  
Zhiyuan Zeng\*, Hamish Ivison\*, Yiping Wang\*, Lifan Yuan\*, Shuyue Stella Li, Zhuorui Ye, **Siting Li**, Jacqueline He, Runlong Zhou, Tong Chen, Chenyang Zhao, Yulia Tsvetkov, Simon Shaolei Du, Natasha Jaques, Hao Peng, Pang Wei Koh, Hannaneh Hajishirzi  
2025

2. What Makes for Robust Multi-Modal Models in the Face of Missing Modalities? [\[link\]](#)  
**Siting Li**\*, Chenzhuang Du\*, Yue Zhao, Yu Huang, Hang Zhao  
2023

3. Training-Free Robust Multimodal Learning via Sample-Wise Jacobian Regularization [\[link\]](#)  
Zhengqi Gao, Sucheng Ren, Zihui Xue, **Siting Li**, Hang Zhao  
2022

4. Difference-in-Differences: Bridging Normalization and Disentanglement in PG-GAN [\[link\]](#)  
Xiao Liu\*, Jiajie Zhang\*, **Siting Li**\*, Zuatong Wu, Yang Yu  
2020

Honors and scholarships

|                                                                                            |            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Paul G. Allen First-Year Graduate Student Fellowship, Univ. of Washington                  | 2023       |
| Spark Scientific and Technological Innovation Fellowship, Tsinghua University              | 2021       |
| • top 1% of 3800+ Tsinghua '23 undergraduate students for outstanding research performance |            |
| Silver Medal (Rank 21/318) in China Collegiate Programming Contest (Regional, Harbin)      | 2021       |
| Gold Medal in National Olympiad in Informatics (Invitational)                              | 2018       |
| First Prize in National Olympiad in Informatics in Provinces                               | 2016, 2017 |

Service and leadership

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Teaching Assistant of CSEP 590A Deep Learning, Univ. of Washington                           | Jan. 2026 – Mar. 2026  |
| Teaching Assistant of CSE 543 Deep Learning, Univ. of Washington                             | Sept. 2024 – Dec. 2024 |
| Ph.D. Pre-Application Mentorship Service (PAMS) Mentor, Univ. of Washington                  | 2024                   |
| Council Member of Spark Innovative Talent Cultivation Program, Tsinghua University           | Sept. 2021 – Jun. 2023 |
| • Working on the review committee of the Spark Fellowship and as an organizer of Spark Days. |                        |

Skills

**Programming Languages** : C/C++, Python, Go, LaTeX  
**Framework** : PyTorch  
**Natural Languages** : Chinese (Native), English (Proficient)